BREAKTHROUGH BASKETBALL

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TEAM OFFENSE DEVELOPMENT

Table of Contents

Table of Contents **1**

Chapter One: Offensive Concepts **4**

5 Things That Make Up Great Offense 5

Chapter Three: Ball Security **6**

Ball Toughness 6

1v0 Create space 6

1v1 Stationary 6

1v1 Live 6

Chapter Four: Passing, Catching and Cutting **7**

3-Man Stationary Passing 7

Cutting to Score 7

Cutting to Get open 8

V Cut - Face Cut 8

Fill Cut - Rear Cut - Backdoor 9

Chapter Five: Offensive Build - Up **10**

1v1 Live 10

2v0 10

2v2 Live 11

3v0 12

3v3 13

4v0 13

4v4 13

5v0 - 5v5 No Post 14

5v0 - 5v5 Temporary Post 15

Chapter Six: Penetrate and Pitch **16**

Being Shot Ready 16

2v0 16

2v2 17

3v3 18

Chapter Seven: Dribble Hand-Off **19**

Chapter Eight: 5v5 **21**

Chapter Nine: Cutters **22**

Cut and Fill 22

Unbalanced Floor 22

Chapter Ten: Away Screens **24**

Screener - the emphasis of the screener should be: 24

Player Coming Off Screen - The emphasis of the player coming off the screen should be: 24

Chapter Eleven: Ball Screens **26**

Chapter One: Offensive Concepts

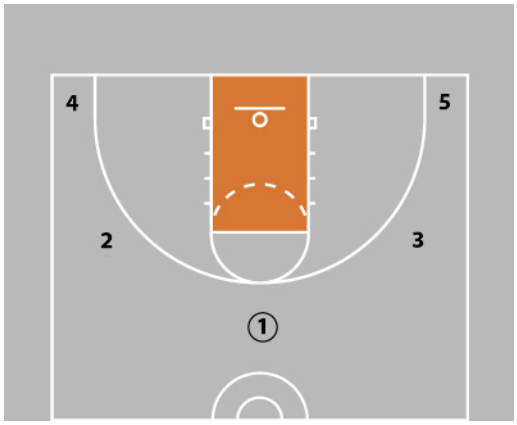
Teaching motion offense to the youth is very important. We need to teach kids how to play rather than teaching them how to run a play. The Motion Offense allows you to teach players concepts. Once your players master spacing, ball movement, and player movement then you can begin to add layers to the offense such as handoffs, ball screens, and away screens.

Youth basketball should be positionless. Running a patterned offense with youth can be detrimental to their development. A player can be 6’0 in 7th grade and asked to play with their back to the basket to win games. It’s possible that the same kid is now a sophomore in high school and hasn't grown. They can’t get away with the same things in high school that they got away with in middle school and now they lack the skills necessary to move to the perimeter.

By developing a positionless basketball offense, you will be developing the skills of every player equally, which should be a goal when coaching youth basketball players.

Chapter Two: 5v0 Introduction

At the beginning, show them the finished product.



Take the 5 kids and space them on the perimeter.

- The ball should be at the top of the key
- A player occupying each corner
- A player occupying each wing

Numbers are arbitrary, remember this is a positionless offense.

5 Things That Make Up Great Offense

1. **Great spacing** - Depending on the strength of your players you want about 15 feet of space between players. Offense is spacing. Spacing is offense.
2. **Ball movement** - Ball reversals break down the defense.
3. **Player movement** - Pass and move - teach 3 options after pass: on ball screen, off ball screen, cut to basket.
4. **Take uncontested, high percentage shots** - If a kid can make an uncontested shot in practice at 50%. That is a good shot to shoot in a game. “It’s not your shot, it’s our shot” make it count.
5. **Have skilled players** - Prioritize skill development.

Chapter Three: Ball Security

Ball Toughness

Low Ball Rips - Have players sit in a stance. Rip the ball low and violently from side to side. Keep the ball connected. Elbow at 90 degree angle at all times. Do not extend elbows essentially disconnecting the ball from the body.

- *High Ball Rips* - Rip across the forehead with the same 90 degree angle.
- *Combo Rips* - Have players mix high and low rips simultaneously.

1v0 Create space

Creating space to face up to the basket. Simulating a defender in your players' bubble we want to create some space. Have players step into the imaginary defender without lunging and getting an offensive foul. Have a player stay within the frame they create with their step, meaning don't allow players shoulders to go beyond their feet. With this "jab" / pivot step. Incorporate high and low rips to build ball toughness.

1v1 Stationary

Offense starts facing the basket. Defense is harassing the ball handler if the defender fouls that is ok. Offense must be strong with the ball and face the basket for the duration of the drill.

Next progression. Offense is facing away from the basket, now the offense needs to work to face up and proceed to handle pressure while facing the basket.

1v1 Live

Offense has to handle pressure with rips and jabs until the coach says "Go" at this time the offense can attack the basket in a 1v1 situation.

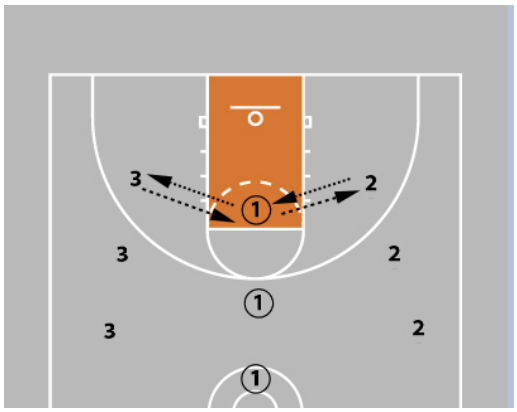
These are development drills. Emphasis essential skills needed to be successful.

- Example: Driving in a straight line, staying low, absorbing contact, etc.

Chapter Four: Passing, Catching and Cutting

Passing and catching are under emphasized skills in today's game. The ooh's and ah's generally trend toward dribble moves and fancy finishes. Players that can pass and catch at a high level make the game easier for themselves and essentially their teammates as well.

3-Man Stationary Passing



- In Groups of 3. Coach will designate a pivot foot to which each player will step into their pass stepping in with the appropriate foot.
- Players should lock their elbow and snap their wrist.
- As each player receives a pass. They should catch the ball in the triple threat position. "Ball in the air; Feet in the air"

Cutting to Score

Players cutting to the basket is one of the times where being selfish pays off. If a player cuts hard to score, the team has a great opportunity for 2 points **or** that player has likely gained the attention of one or more **extra** defenders, thus freeing up a teammate. Be selfish, cut hard to score every time.

Cuts for a score should be to the front of the rim for 2 reasons:

1. An easier pass to make for the passer. This will shorten the length of the pass slightly and ensure that the cutter is not drifting away from the passer on their cut.
2. If the cutter catches and they do not have a strong side finish they have a much better chance to get to the opposite side for a reverse or if he/she is cut off can make a pass to the perimeter easier because they are not stuck behind the basket or on the 3rd of the floor that they started on.

Cutting to Get open

Cutting to get open is important for a number of reasons:

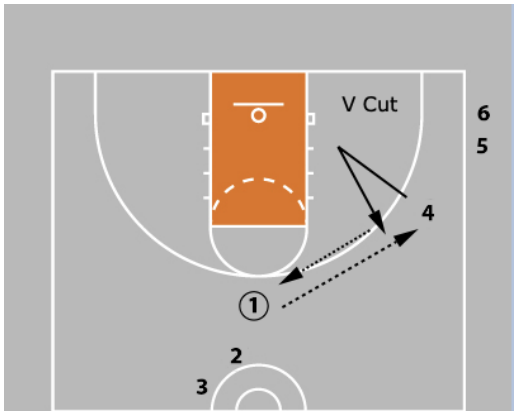
- Your best player needs to get the ball.
- Someone needs to catch in a specific spot to run a set.
- Your ball handler is being harassed and someone needs to relieve pressure.

In general being able to get open creates safer passes and can lower turnover rates.

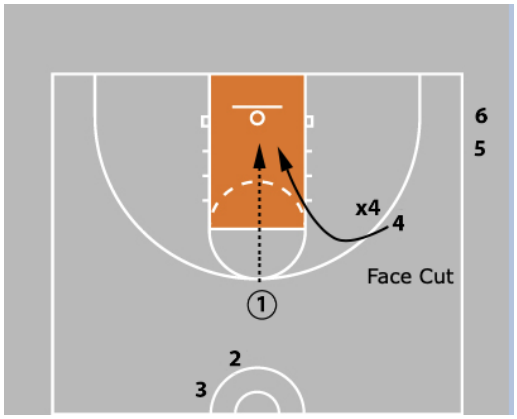
V Cut - Face Cut

This drill can help develop multiple skills while incorporating cutting to score and cutting to get open.

- Player 4 will V cut to get open.
- A coach can step in and play defense to get an idea of what a game situation would look like.
- Player 4 will receive a pass and while using the “ball in the air feet in the air” approach and proceed to return the pass to Player 1.

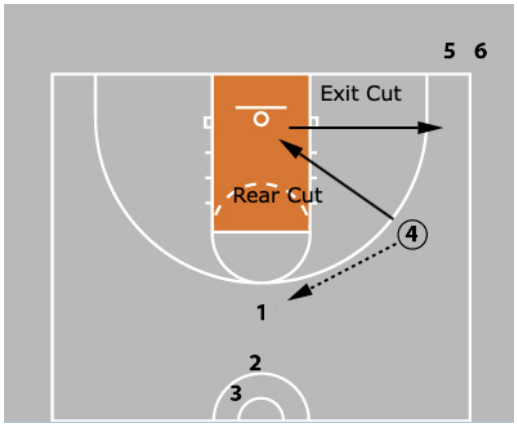


- After player 4 returns the pass and makes the read that x4 has not jumped to the ball, player 4 will then Face Cut x4 and receive a pass for a layup.

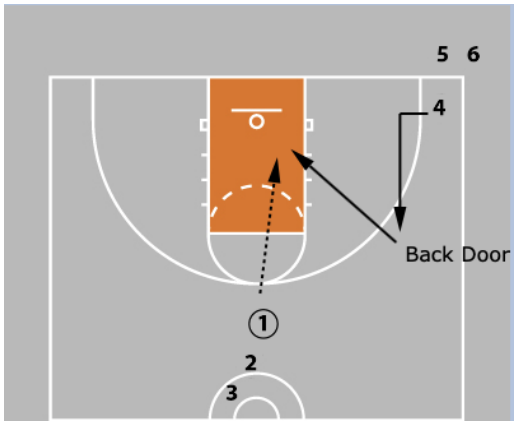


Fill Cut - Rear Cut - Backdoor

1. Player 4 will Fill Cut to the wing and receive a pass from 1.
2. Working on being in a triple threat position on the catch.
3. 4 will return the pass and rather than face cutting, 4 will Rear Cut (cut behind the defender.)
4. When 4 does not receive a pass for a score he/she will Exit Cut back to the corner.



- 4 will Fill Cut again.
- This time 4 will be overplayed and Back Door Cut.
- 1 will hit 4 for a layup.
- Players rotate lines and continue.

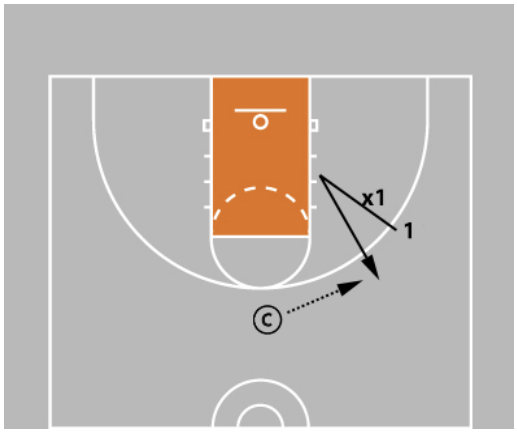


Chapter Five: Offensive Build-Up

1v1 Live

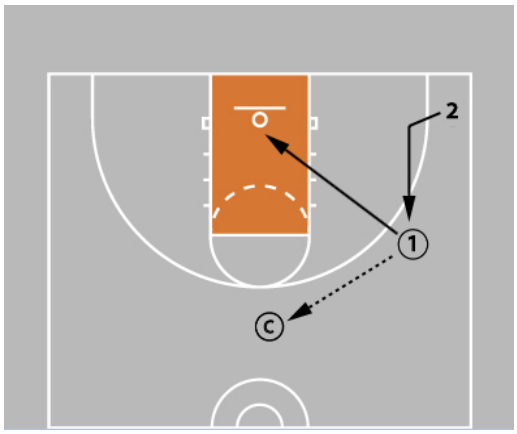
Having good 1v1 players translates directly into 5v5. If you are a better 1v1 offensive player, team offense has a higher ceiling. If you have good 1v1 Defenders team defense has a higher ceiling. Do not undervalue 1v1 done the correct way.

- Coach will start with the ball.
- Player 1 will cut to get open on the perimeter and the drill is live.
- Player 1 may return the pass to the coach once and cut to score or cut to get open again.

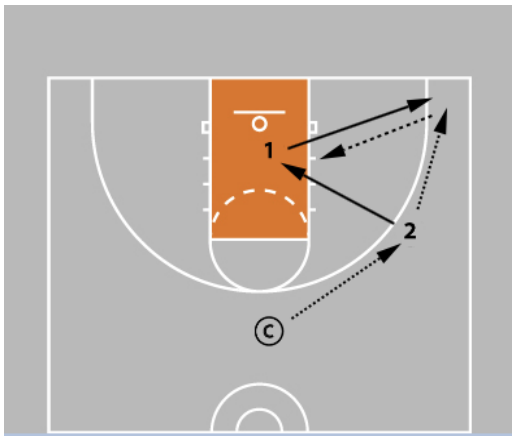


2v0

- In this drill emphasize air passes. Air passes, unlike bounce passes, are faster, generally more accurate, and easier to catch especially on the run. The window to throw a bounce pass is also much smaller than the window of time an air pass is available.

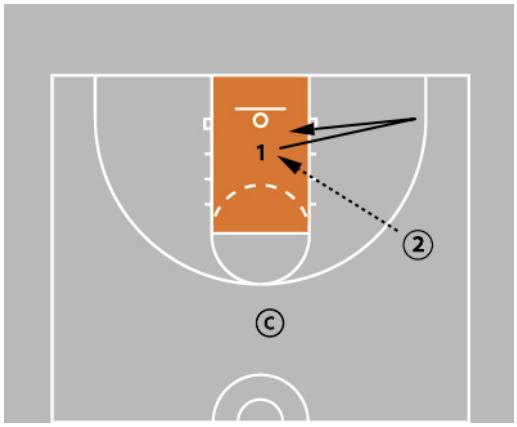


- As player 2 catches the ball in triple threat. Player 1 should be in the process of Exit Cutting.
- Player 2 will reverse the ball to the corner occupied by Player 1, Basket Cut, and receive a pass for a layup.



Progression

- As player 1 is Exit Cutting, Back Door Cut for a layup.
- These shots will be along the Baseline and can be a difficult finish off of one foot without a great angle to use the backboard.
- Emphasis a 2 foot stop and square. 10 toes facing the baseline and using the top corner of the square.



2v2 Live

Now everything that has been covered to this point is in play. Passing and cutting in live action. In this drill the defense will be required to pressure everywhere. This is necessary to develop the skills needed to punish pressure and loosen it up.

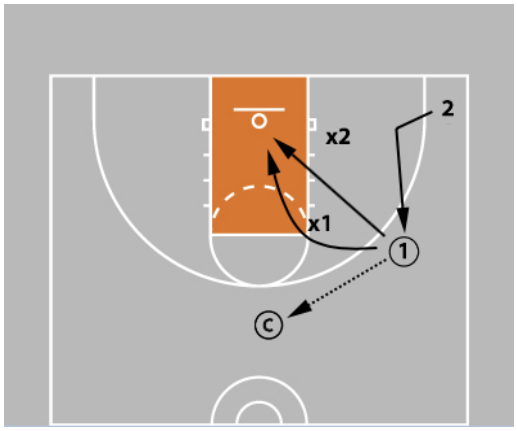
Rules:

1. Ball starts with player 1 and throws to Coach at the top of the key initiates the possession.
2. Start no dribble. Progress to 1 dribble, then 2 dribbles.

3. Use 1 side of the floor
4. Defense **must** pressure passes and catches.
5. Offense is trying to score on a Face Cut, Rear Cut, or a Backdoor Cut.

Reminders for players:

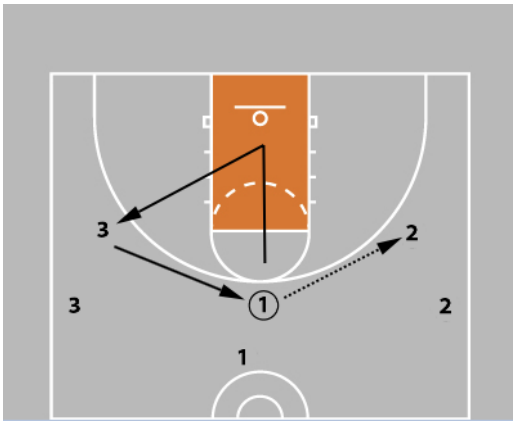
- Look for the ball on all cuts.
- Cut selfishly! Cut to score!
- Finish your cut at the basket.
- Create contact when trying to get open if needed.

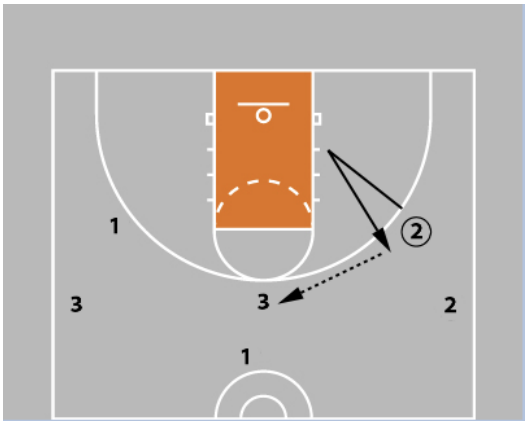


3v0

- V cut to get open
- Finish cuts to the rim
- Ball in the air feet in the air on all catches
- Fill in a straight line to the wing
- Look for basketball on all cuts.

*Coaches if you want to add a small layer, step out and deny a fill reversal forcing a back door and another fill. *





3v3

- Use 3v0 set up and add a passive dummy defense and 0 dribbles at first.

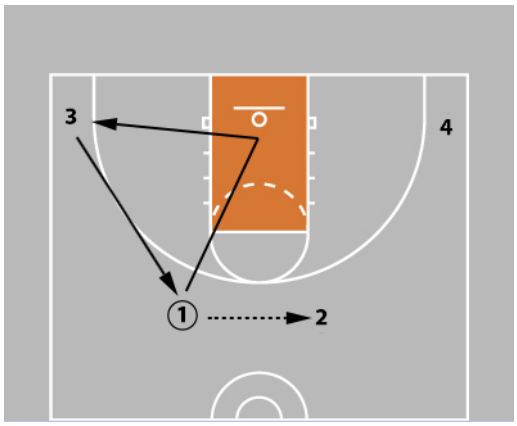
    - Players should change speeds and cut hard
- Offense is looking to score on cuts so make sure players are catching in triple threat using “ball in the air feet in the air” footwork so they don’t miss the opportunity to hit a cutter for a score.

Adding dribbles

- When adding dribbles make players understand that if they use a dribble it is to get a **layup**, **shorten a pass, or provide balance to the floor**
- Encourage open uncontested jump shots
- Ball reversals = open driving lanes.
- If players are not open on a cut they need to get out with urgency. Keep the lane open for cutters and drivers

4v0

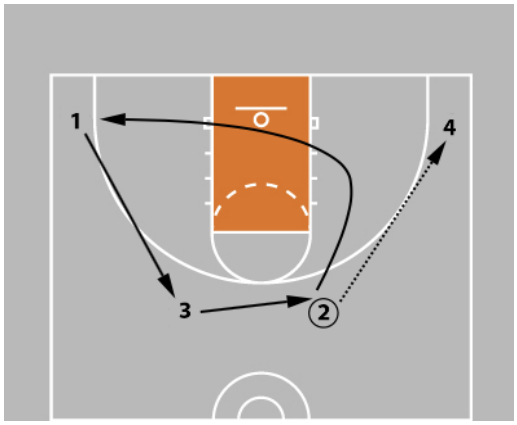
- All cuts are in play. After a player finishes cutting in the rim. Exit Cut to the Corner that’s open.
- Players should fill spots toward where the ball is passed, opening a spot for cutters to exit.



4v4

Use 4v0 spots to play 4v4

- Cut to get open. Cut to score.
    - Players should always look at Face Cut first.
- Backdoor if overplayed and Fill Cut from the next spot.



    - Players will want to start a back cut and pop out to the spot they came from. Discourage this. If you start a back cut you have to finish it. Do NOT dance.

- No dribbles.
    - If a player catches a cut and needs a dribble to get to the rim for a layup, allow the dribble.

- Add any amount of dribbles you think is necessary. 2 or 3 dribbles are recommended as long as straight line drives are emphasized and useless dribbles are eliminated. Coach can blow a possession dead for using dribbles ineffectively.

5v0 - 5v5 No Post

5v0

Dribble handoffs occur when the ball handler dribbles at a teammate and not before. If a player receives a handoff they should be looking to score. Maintain spacing! Pass and cut! Emphasize Sprint Cuts!

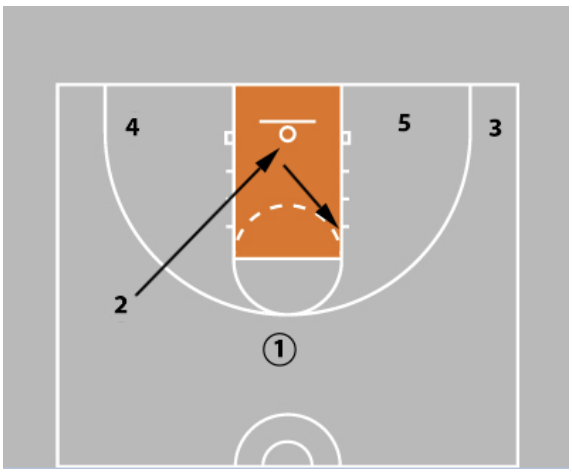
5v5 Live

Playing to score. 3 dribble limit handoffs are now available to players. Still emphasizing all of the spacing and cutting concepts covered to this point.

5v0 - 5v5 Temporary Post

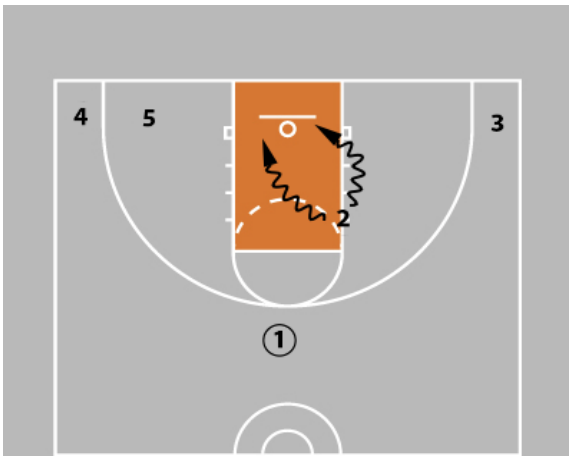
Rules for a temporary post:

- Finish cut to the rim.
- Post under the rim momentarily for a potential no dribble / no post move needed finish.
- Move out to the first hash
- Post hard and call for the ball
- Pop out after one pass is made.



Tips for a Post-Up:

- Get low
- Get wide
- Call for the ball
- Make contact with the defender



When a player is cutting they have an option to temporarily post by straddling the first hash before getting out. The first hash is essential because if a player posts on the block it is difficult to utilize the baseline side to score out of the post. Elevating the catch to the first hash allows a post move to go toward the middle and baseline leaving more options at the post player's disposal.

After a post entry players can Laker Cut. Be patient in the post and players need to look in as well. Patience on both sides.

5v5 - No jump shots until 2 temporary posts have occurred

Chapter Six: Penetrate and Pitch

Driving the ball to the basket should try to accomplish one of two things.

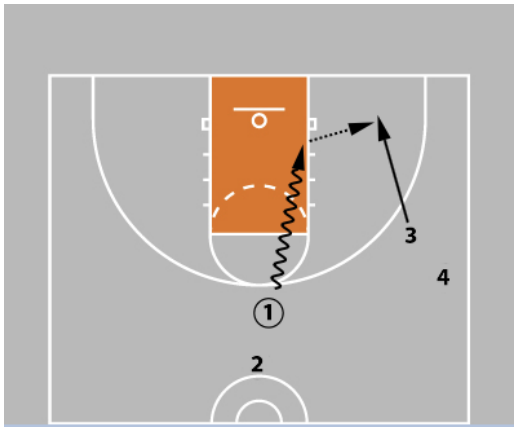
1. Get a layup for the ball handler
2. Draw help and find a teammate that has a better opportunity to score.

It is important for a player without the ball to relocate to a position on the court where it will be easy for the ball handler to deliver a pass on time and on target along with being in a spot where it will be difficult for his/her defender to recover. It is equally important that when receiving a pass, the player needs to be shot ready.

Being Shot Ready

- Hips down (quarter squat)
- Show hands to the passer
- Catch the ball while feet are in the air.
- Land ready to shoot.

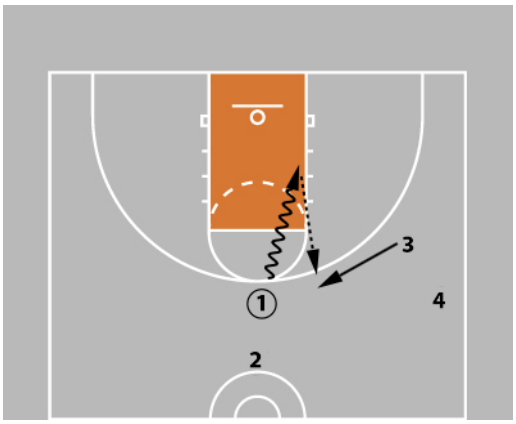
2v0



- Being great at Penetrate and Pitch will create long closeouts allowing players to either get open shots or blow-by drives to the basket. It is important for the receiver to use “ball in the air feet in the air” footwork. **Be ready to shoot on the catch.**

- The ball handler must be explosive toward the rim to either get a layup for themselves or attract multiple defenders to deliver a pass. Passes must be delivered on time and on target so the receiver has the opportunity to shoot an in rhythm shot. The ball handler must also protect the ball, move to the right dribble with the right hand. Stay low on the drive.

- **Wing drift to the corner -** the ball handler is able to get between X1 and X3 creating an open passing lane

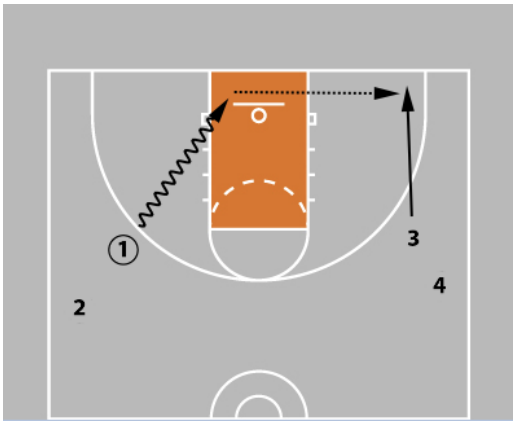


- Straight line drive to initiate drill.

- Ball handler stops momentum on drive to avoid a charge.

- **Wing circle behind** - When the wing defender gets sucked in on the drive.

- **Baseline Drive Drift -** When the ball handler is putting pressure on the rim baseline side they need a passing option if the layup is unavailable.

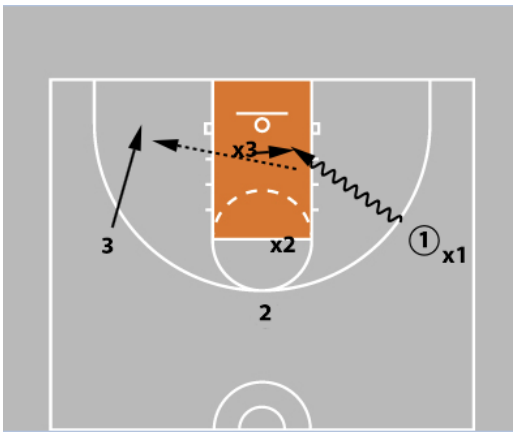


2v2

- Stay on one side.
- Make x2 commit to the ball before passing to a teammate.
- Defense is live on the dribble.

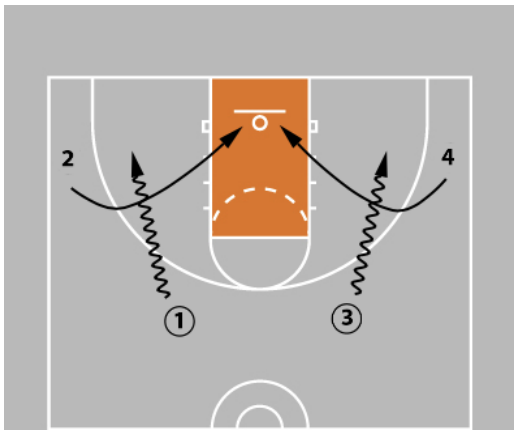
3v3

- Make a defender commit to the ball before making a pass.



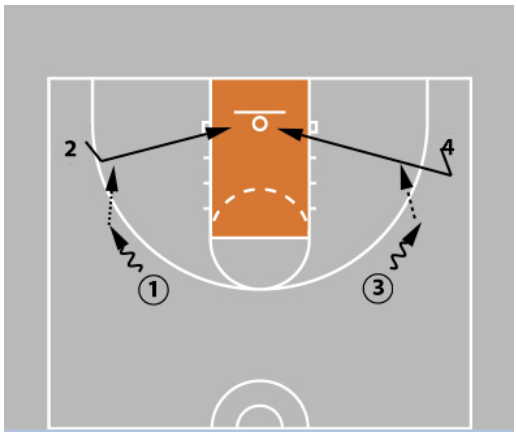
Chapter Seven: Dribble Hand-Off

- If Defender is tight - backdoor
- If defender is sagging - handoff and get downhill (2 feet in the paint)
- Ball handler must dribble inside the 3 point line.



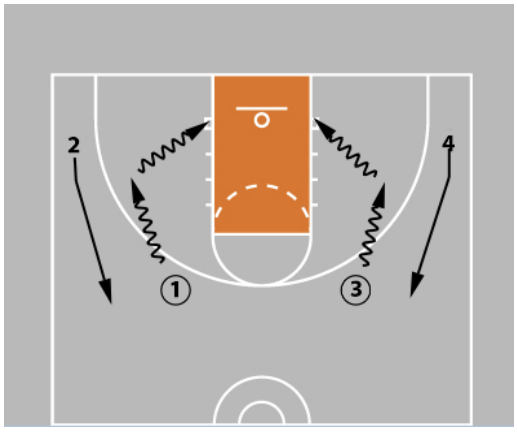
Back-door

- When going back door, make sure the cutter shows their hand ONLY only on the cut toward the hoop
- Passer can make a pass fake as well before hitting cutter backdoor



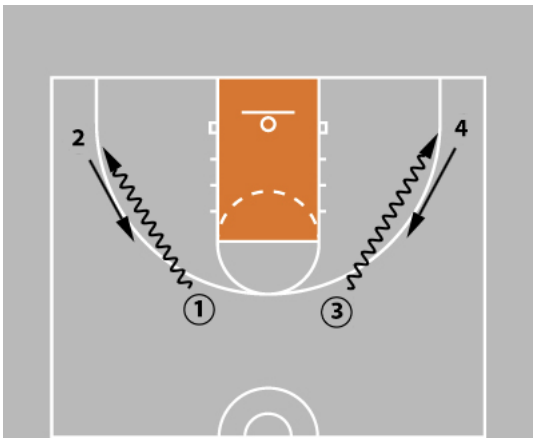
Fake Hand-Off

- Make sure players are getting the same depth that they would if they were doing the normal handoff

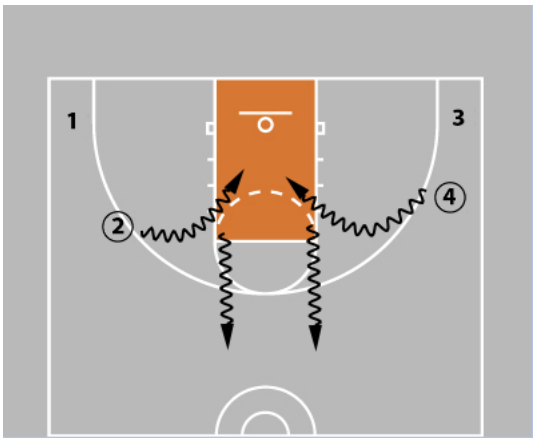


2v2 Hand-Offs

1. Same set up. Both groups can go at the same time or stagger them if you need to.
2. Try to turn the corner on every handoff.



3. Back dribble to reset.
4. Back doors and fake handoffs are available.



3v3

1. 3 dribble max
2. No jump shots until at least 2 dribble handoffs.
3. Only open uncontested shots allowed
4. Layups are always allowed whenever you can get them

Chapter Eight: 5v5

Put everything together to this point and play 5v5 with limited dribbles.

25 Point Game

1. Reversal = 3 points
2. OReb. = 2 Points
3. Pass = 1 Point
4. Basket = 2 Points
5. TO = -2 Points

Defense gets the ball after a stop or a turnover. First to 25 points wins.

Feel free to adjust scoring to impact your team goals. Think about what your team strengths and weaknesses are. Are you a team who does not crash the offense boards? Make Offensive Rebounds worth 4. Are you a team who turns the ball over? Make TOs worth 4 and deflections worth 1 or 2 points.

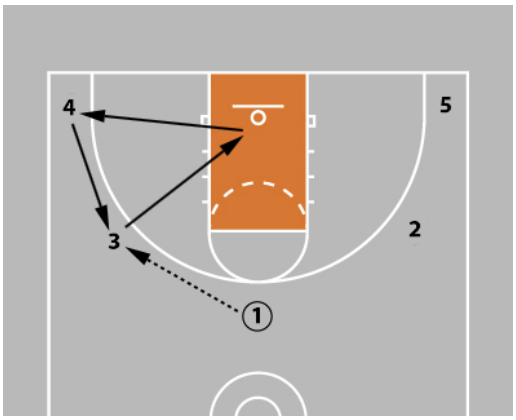
Remember, the more competitive reps you give your players the better prepared they will be on gameday. Hold your players accountable!

Chapter Nine: Cutters

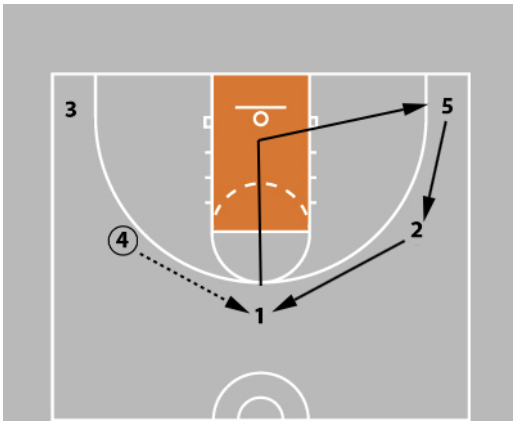
Points of emphasis in 5v0 Cutters

1. **Passing to the outside hand** - On the perimeter the safest place to throw the ball is to the outside hand or the outside shoulder of the player receiving the pass.
2. **Cutting hard to the basket showing inside hand.**
3. **Going backdoor if overplayed or opportunity presents itself.**
4. **Attacking off the dribble** - Constant passing and cutting should open decent sized gaps for a ball handler to take their defender off the dribble with a higher probability to have a chance at a layup.
5. **Facing up to the hoop** - Every time a player catches the ball they need to be able to see teammates come open on cuts or open lanes to drive.

Cut and Fill

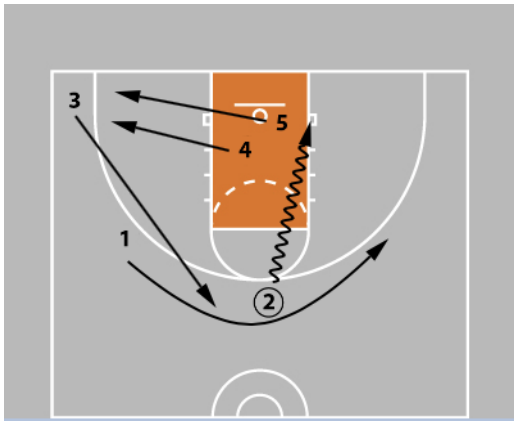


Unbalanced Floor

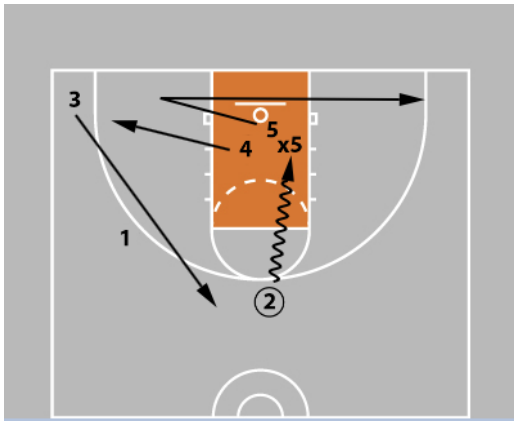


There are a number of situations that can arise that could lead to an unbalanced floor. All of these situations are okay! The only way to mess the offense up is by attempting to fix it. Commit to cuts and continue to play.

- In this situation 4 and 5 can go to the empty side of course, but if they go to the side fully occupied then the ball handler just has a great opportunity to drive right handed with no help on that side. 3 and 1 can fill behind creating space for 4 and 5 to occupy.



- If however, 4 and 5 start to Exit cut, and 4 changes their mind to go to the opposite side because he or she thinks they made a mistake. It can lead to congestion at the rim not allowing the ball handler to get to the basket and no option to pass to the player's man who is helping.



Chapter Ten: Away Screens

It is recommended that if you decide to implement away screens, require them to curl every time. This will allow the kids to play hard and quickly without worrying about having to make reads right away.

Screener - *the emphasis of the screener should be:*

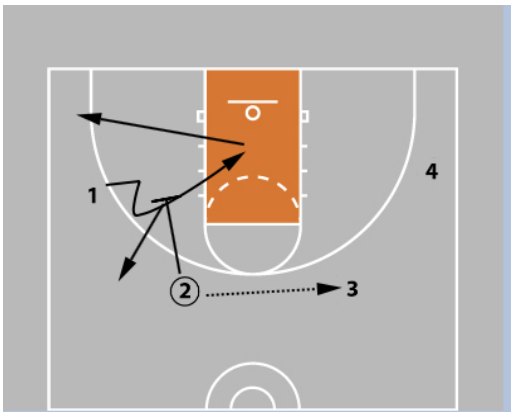
1. **Take 1-2 steps toward the basket** - This will set up the screener to be in a tougher position to apply help. This will also allow the screener to get a good angle on the screen.
2. **Sprint into screen**
3. **Plant feet**
4. **Get wide**
5. **Communicate screen**

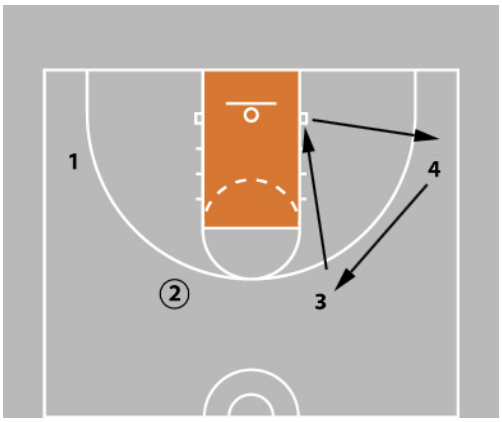
Setting great screens often open up the screener for a shot opportunity

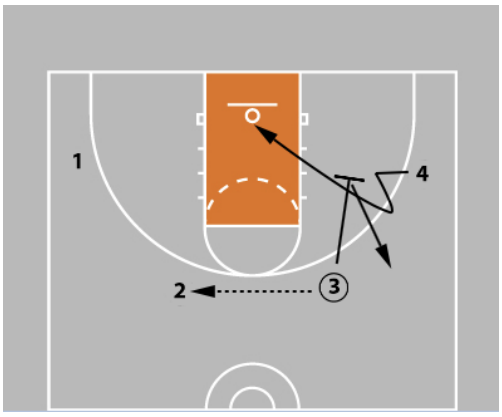
Player Coming Off Screen - *The emphasis of the player coming off the screen should be:*

1. **Setup his/her defender by getting to level of the screen**
2. **Come off screen shoulder to hip**
3. **Cut to basket.**
4. **Give target hand(s)**

- Start 4v0 continuous described below and move to 4v4 when they become ready.






1
4
2
3

Chapter Eleven: Ball Screens

Emphasis For Screener

1. **Take a step or 2 toward the basket** - This will set up the defender and improve the screening angle.
2. **Sprint to screen** - Screeners goal should be to arrive alone or his/her defender late to the screening action.
3. **Butt down feet wide**
4. **Make sure you are set**
5. **Roll or run to basket**

Emphasis For Ball Handler

1. **Come off shoulder to hip**
2. **Get to nail or middle of the paint**
3. **Attack hard**

4v0 and 4v4 options - Pass to wing and cut, set an Away screen, hand-off, or ball screen.

When playing, as a coach try to remind them about ways to keep the floor balanced and the options they have while playing.